

HireConn Backend — 16-Week Implementation Roadmap & Weekly Milestone Tracker

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Start Date: October 5, 2026
Target Production Launch: January 24, 2027 (16 Weeks)

1. Baseline Audit of Existing Code vs Gaps to Bridge

An audit of your existing repository reveals that only the architectural foundation is present.

What Is Already Done:

- Repository Setup:** Basic microservice repository structure is in place.
 - Architectural Skeleton:** Service directories (`api-gateway/` , `identity-profile-service/` , `feed-service/` , `jobs-service/` , `chat-service/` , `notification-service/` , `ai-assistant-service/`) have been initialized with their foundational frameworks (Django/FastAPI).
 - Infrastructure Planning:** High-level architecture design is completed, but no database models, business logic, or API endpoints have been implemented yet.
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What Remains to Be Done (The Next 16-Week Scope):

To achieve **100% parity with the Flutter frontend application**, the entire backend feature set must be built from scratch within the architectural skeleton:

- API Gateway:** Django-based reverse proxy routing and aggregation.
 - Auth Service:** User registration, activation, OTP, login, token refresh, forgot password, Incognito Mode, Account Deletion, and authenticated password change.
 - Profile Service:**
 - Personal Profile creation, bios, work, interests taxonomy, 6-photo carousel.
 - Business Profile creation, categories, licensing, operating hours, contact privacy.
 - Profile Linking & 1-tap switching.
 - Social Graph & Search:** Connection requests, mutual connections, business watchers, Discover Geo-Distance Search Engine, Find a Business Search Engine, QR scan instant resolution.
 - Feed Service:** Post creation (Reflection, Question, Announcement, Resource), durations, rich attachments, recommendation timelines, 6 sentiment reactions, 6 typed comments, threaded replies, and bookmarks.
 - Jobs Service:** Opportunity creation, job applications with resume uploads, express interest flows, and employer review dashboards.
 - Chat Service:** Real-time Socket.IO chat, 1:1 conversations, media attachments, edits, unsends, pinning, embedded cards, and translation.
 - Notifications & AI Assistant:** In-app feeds, push notifications, email templates, and Vine AI rewriting proxy.
 - End-to-End Flutter Integration:** Full integration with the frontend app and production launch.
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2. 16-Week Master Milestone Roadmap

Phase	Weeks	Target Dates	Focus Domain & Key Deliverables
Phase 1: Gateway, Auth & Profiles	W01 – W04	Oct 5 – Nov 1, 2026	API Gateway routing, User registration/login, Personal & Business Profile CRUD, Profile linking, Verification requests.
Phase 2: Social & Search	W05 – W08	Nov 2 – Nov 29, 2026	Connection requests, Mutual connections, Business watchers, Discover geo-distance search engine, Find Business search, QR identity system.
Phase 3: Feed & Jobs	W09 – W12	Nov 30 – Dec 27, 2026	Post types, Expiration durations, Sentiment reactions, Typed comments with media, Threaded replies, Job opportunities & candidate review.
Phase 4: Chat, AI & Launch	W13 – W16	Dec 28, 2026 – Jan 24, 2027	Socket.IO chat engine, Media & reactions in chat, Push/Email notifications, Vine AI assistant, End-to-end integration, and Production Launch.

3. Week-by-Week Detailed Breakdown & "What I Am Done" Checklists

PHASE 1: Gateway, Auth & Profile Implementation (Weeks 1 – 4)

Week 1: API Gateway, Media Uploads & Core Authentication

Dates: October 5, 2026 – October 11, 2026

Goal: Build the API Gateway reverse proxy, set up S3 uploads, and implement core user authentication (signup, login, OTP).

- ☐ **GW-01** : Implement API Gateway reverse proxy routing to backend services.
- ☐ **CORE-01** : Deploy central media upload pre-signed URL generator (`POST /api/media/v1/presign-upload/`).
- ☐ **AUTH-01** : Implement User registration, OTP generation, and account activation.
- ☐ **AUTH-02** : Implement Login, JWT token generation, and token refresh.
- ☐ **AUTH-03** : Implement Forgot Password and authenticated password change.
- ☐ **AUTH-04** : Implement Incognito Mode toggle and Account soft deletion.

Week 2: Personal Profile Service

Dates: October 12, 2026 – October 18, 2026

Goal: Build Personal Profile creation, bio management, interests taxonomy, and photo carousels.

- ☐ **PROF-01** : Create `Profile` models and basic CRUD endpoints (`MeProfileView`).
- ☐ **PROF-02** : Implement `feed_profile_tagline` , `work` fields, and bio constraints.
- ☐ **PROF-03** : Implement 6-photo carousel array handling and reordering.
- ☐ **PROF-04** : Create master `Interest` taxonomy seed database and selection endpoints.
- ☐ **PROF-05** : Enforce public profile visibility rules (suppress incognito profiles).

Week 3: Business Profile Service

Dates: October 19, 2026 – October 25, 2026

Goal: Build Business Profiles with sub-categories, licensing, operating hours, and contact privacy.

- ☐ **PROF-06** : Create Business Profile models (sub-categories, insurance, licensing, languages, years active).
- ☐ **PROF-07** : Implement business weekly operating hours schedule endpoint.
- ☐ **PROF-08** : Implement business contact information endpoint with public/private visibility toggles.
- ☐ **PROF-09** : Ensure public preview endpoints respect privacy toggles.

Week 4: Profile Linking, Settings & Verification

Dates: October 26, 2026 – November 1, 2026

Goal: Build account linking between Personal Profile and Business Page, context switching, and user settings.

- ☐ **PROF-10** : Implement `ProfileLink` table and 1-tap profile context switching.
 - ☐ **PROF-11** : Business verification badge request submission and status tracking.
 - ☐ **PROF-12** : Sync communication email preferences and privacy settings.
 - ☐ **PROF-13** : First name change request intake.
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PHASE 2: Social Graph, Discovery Engine & QR System (Weeks 5 – 8)

Week 5: Connection Requests & Active Connections

Dates: November 2, 2026 – November 8, 2026

Goal: Build connection request workflow (send, accept, decline, withdraw) and active connections management.

- ☐ **SOC-01** : Create `Connection` model and implement request endpoints.
- ☐ **SOC-02** : Implement action endpoints: accept, decline, withdraw.
- ☐ **SOC-03** : Implement pending request lists with cursor pagination.
- ☐ **SOC-04** : Implement active connections list and remove connection endpoint.

Week 6: Mutual Connections & Business Watchers

Dates: November 9, 2026 – November 15, 2026

Goal: Calculate mutual connections and deliver business "Watch" subscriptions.

- ☐ **SOC-05** : Implement mutual connections intersection algorithm.
- ☐ **SOC-06** : Implement business watch/unwatch endpoints.
- ☐ **SOC-07** : Implement business owner watchers listing and search.
- ☐ **SOC-08** : Implement personal user watched businesses list.

Week 7: Discover Geo-Distance Search Engine & Blocked Accounts

Dates: November 16, 2026 – November 22, 2026

Goal: Build nearby personal profile discovery engine and user blocking.

- ☐ **SOC-09** : Integrate geospatial distance calculation (PostGIS/Haversine).
- ☐ **SOC-10** : Implement Discovery endpoint with filters (Gender, Age, Location, Distance, Shared interests).
- ☐ **SOC-11** : Implement user blocking system and suppress blocked/incognito users from search.

Week 8: Find a Business Search & QR Identity Resolution

Dates: November 23, 2026 – November 29, 2026

Goal: Implement full-text business search and QR code generation/resolution.

- ☐ **SOC-12** : Implement basic and advanced business search endpoints.
 - ☐ **SOC-13** : QR code token issuance endpoint.
 - ☐ **SOC-14** : QR resolution endpoint returning full profile data for scanned codes.
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PHASE 3: Feed Engine, Comments & Job Opportunities (Weeks 9 - 12)

Week 9: Social Post Publishing & Rich Attachments

Dates: November 30, 2026 – December 6, 2026

Goal: Build Post models, expiry lifecycles, and rich attachment support.

- ☐ **FEED-01** : Create `Post` model with `post_type` and `post_duration` fields.
- ☐ **FEED-02** : Support background context notes and visibility targeting.
- ☐ **FEED-03** : Implement rich attachments (galleries, video, PDF, audio).
- ☐ **FEED-04** : Implement post edit and delete endpoints.

Week 10: Recommendation Timelines, Reactions & Bookmarks

Dates: December 7, 2026 – December 13, 2026

Goal: Build recommendation timeline queries and 6-sentiment reactions.

- ☐ **FEED-05** : Implement timeline endpoint with pagination and recommendation ranking.
- ☐ **FEED-06** : Build multi-sentiment reaction system with atomic counters.
- ☐ **FEED-07** : Implement bookmark/save post endpoint and saved posts query.
- ☐ **FEED-08** : Implement repost endpoint.

Week 11: Typed Comments, Threaded Replies & Activities

Dates: December 14, 2026 – December 20, 2026

Goal: Build 6 typed comments, threaded replies, and feed activity dashboards.

- ☐ **FEED-09** : Create `Comment` model supporting 6 types and media attachments.
- ☐ **FEED-10** : Implement threaded recursive replies.
- ☐ **FEED-11** : Implement comment sorting strategies (best discussions, latest, etc.).
- ☐ **FEED-12** : Build Feed activities dashboard endpoints (My Posts, My Comments, My Reactions).

Week 12: Job Opportunities & Candidate Applications

Dates: December 21, 2026 – December 27, 2026

Goal: Build recruitment engine, job postings, and candidate applications.

- ☐ **JOBS-01** : Create `Opportunity` model and job posting endpoints.
 - ☐ **JOBS-02** : Implement opportunity search engine.
 - ☐ **JOBS-03** : Build candidate job application submission with resume uploads and EEOC fields.
 - ☐ **JOBS-04** : Express interest ("Notify") flow for lightweight applications.
 - ☐ **JOBS-05** : Employer candidate review dashboard endpoints.
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PHASE 4: Real-Time Chat, Notifications, AI Assistant & Launch (Weeks 13 – 16)

Week 13: Real-Time Chat Engine

Dates: December 28, 2026 – January 3, 2027

Goal: Build Socket.IO chat service, 1:1 messaging, and media attachments.

- ☐ **CHAT-01** : Deploy Socket.IO cluster with JWT authentication.
- ☐ **CHAT-02** : Build Conversation models, inbox management, and unread counts.
- ☐ **CHAT-03** : Implement real-time message sending and history pagination.
- ☐ **CHAT-04** : Support chat media attachments (photos, videos, PDFs, voice).
- ☐ **CHAT-05** : Implement in-place message editing and unsends.

Week 14: Chat Reactions, Pins, Embeds & Broadcasts

Dates: January 4, 2027 – January 10, 2027

Goal: Deliver advanced chat features (reactions, pins, translation).

- ☐ **CHAT-06** : Implement message pinning and quick navigation.
- ☐ **CHAT-07** : Real-time message reactions with emoji pickers.
- ☐ **CHAT-08** : Support embedded post/comment cards in chat.
- ☐ **CHAT-09** : In-chat message translation endpoint.
- ☐ **CHAT-10** : Business "Message Watchers" broadcast endpoint.

Week 15: Notifications & Vine AI Assistant

Dates: January 11, 2027 – January 17, 2027

Goal: Deploy event consumers, notifications, and AI features.

- ☐ **NOTIF-01** : Build Celery/RabbitMQ event consumers for platform events.
- ☐ **NOTIF-02** : Implement in-app notification feed.
- ☐ **NOTIF-03** : Integrate Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) & Apple APNs for push notifications.
- ☐ **NOTIF-04** : Transactional email dispatch honoring user preferences.
- ☐ **AI-01** : Build Vine AI rewriting proxy for text expansion/shortening/tone.

Week 16: Security Audit, Load Testing & Production Launch

Dates: January 18, 2027 – January 24, 2027

Goal: Finalize system integration, performance tuning, and launch.

- ☐ **SYS-01** : End-to-end regression testing with the Flutter frontend.
- ☐ **SYS-02** : Database performance tuning (indices, query optimization).
- ☐ **SYS-03** : Security audit (JWT checks, Gateway rate limiting, CORS).
- ☐ **SYS-04** : Concurrency load testing.
- ☐ **SYS-05** : Production cloud deployment setup (AWS).
- ☐ **SYS-06** : Final client sign-off and production handover.
- **Final Launch Milestone (Sunday, January 24, 2027):**